FindCare Ghana

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A plain-language guide to the public site, organization administrators, the system-wide superadmin, the facility directory, and analytics and Google setup

Who uses FindCare?

Public visitors	Search for hospitals, clinics, laboratories, pharmacies and medical stores, ambulance services, hearse services and caregivers, and see how busy each one is. No account is needed.
Organization admin	Staff of one listed organization. They sign in to keep that listing up to date: how busy it is, what it offers, beds, fleet, map location and their own password.
Superadmin	Oversees the whole system: reviews contact requests, creates listings and logins, manages directory records and organization admins, and reviews recorded changes.

Contact FindCare Ghana: info@findcareghana.com, and @findcareGh on Instagram, X and Facebook. These appear in the footer of every public page and on the Contact us page.

Important: the directory has not been verified yet. About 2,400 facilities come from OpenStreetMap (section 5) and 59 were entered by hand. Some phone numbers are placeholders and others may be out of date. Do not rely on them in an emergency. The website displays a warning until the information is verified.

This guide explains access and account responsibilities. It is not a medical or emergency-response guide.

1. How an organization gets listed

There is no self-registration. Organizations cannot create their own accounts. Every listing and login is created by a superadmin.

Step 1: the organization contacts us

On the public site, the organization opens **Contact us** and sends its facility name, type, phone number and email, with an optional contact name and message. The types are: Hospital (government), Hospital (private), Clinic, Laboratory / diagnostic centre, Pharmacy / medical store, Ambulance service, Hearse service and Caregiver. A request does not create an account.

Step 2: the superadmin checks and approves

1. Open **/superadmin** and find the request under **Contact requests**.

2. Confirm the organization is real and that the email and phone belong to it, for example by calling the number.

3. Click **Approve and create login**. The form is filled in from the request. Choose the region, and for hospitals and clinics the classification level. Coordinates are optional.

4. Click **Create login**. This creates the listing and a login for the organization's email with a random default password.

If the request is not genuine, click **Reject**. The organization is not told automatically.

Step 3: the superadmin emails the login details

The website does not send email. After saving, the dashboard shows the finished login message once, with the sign-in link, the organization's email and its default password. The superadmin sends it to the organization's email address from their own mailbox, for example info@findcareghana.com:

1. **Open in email app** opens a new email to the organization with the subject and message filled in. Check it and press send.

2. Or **Copy message** and paste it into webmail such as Gmail or Outlook, addressed to the organization's email.

The default password is shown only once, so send the message before leaving the page.

Step 4: the organization signs in and takes over

1. The organization signs in at **https://findcareghana.com/admin** with its email and the default password.

2. It must choose its own password (at least 12 characters) before anything else. From then on only the organization knows its password.

3. It opens **Advanced settings** and sets its map location. It can type the latitude and longitude from Google Maps, or press **Use this device's location** while standing at the entrance. Points outside Ghana are rejected.

4. It keeps its listing current. **How busy are you right now?** sets the red, yellow or green status the public sees for the next 3 hours. **What you offer** has a **Kinds of care** dropdown (Hospital, Clinic, Medical laboratory, Pharmacy and more; tick every one that applies) and the services under each, picked from suggestions or typed in. Hospitals and clinics also tick their **Wards** (children's, female, male) and update bed counts; ambulance services update fleet availability.

A new listing is hidden from public search and emergency mode until its location is set, so no one is sent to a guessed position. If the superadmin enters coordinates when creating the listing, it appears immediately. Emergency mode only ever shows hospitals and clinics.

Changing the password later

Whenever an organization wants a new password, it changes it itself: sign in, open **Advanced settings**, and under **Change password** enter the current password and the new one twice.

Lost password

An organization that cannot sign in contacts FindCare at info@findcareghana.com or @findcareGh. The superadmin then:

1. Confirms it is really them, for example by calling the listing's phone number.

2. Clicks **Reset password** next to their login under **Organization admins**. The lost password stops working at once.

3. Emails them the ready-made "password was reset" message with the new default password, using **Open in email app** or **Copy message**.

The organization signs in with the new default password and must choose its own new password straight away. The superadmin never sees or chooses the organization's own password.

2. Creating the superadmin

Superadmins cannot be created through the website or the demo seed. An authorized operator creates one from the Droplet shell.

Step 1: go to the project folder and run the create command

Use your own email and name:

```
cd /opt/MediFinder
sudo docker compose exec app python -m app.superadmins create you@findcareghana.com "Your Name"
```

Step 2: copy the password it prints

The command generates a strong random password and prints it once, like this:

```
Created superadmin account for you@findcareghana.com.
Password (shown once -- store it in a password manager now):
  mhVXnIu1-E5vz-ImKIC5I2Sr
```

Copy the password straight away into a password manager. It is shown only once, is not stored anywhere in plain text, and is not emailed.

Step 3: sign in

Open **https://findcareghana.com/superadmin** and sign in with that email and password.

If the superadmin password is lost

Generate a new one, printed once in the same way:

```
sudo docker compose exec app python -m app.superadmins reset-password you@findcareghana.com
```

If something goes wrong

An account already uses this email	That email is already a superadmin or an organization login. Use reset-password if it is your superadmin account, or choose another email.
service "app" is not running	Start the app with `sudo docker compose up -d`, then run the create command again.
no configuration file provided	You are in the wrong folder. Run `cd /opt/MediFinder` first.

You can create more superadmins the same way, one email each. Give this access only to people trusted with every account and listing.

3. What the superadmin can manage

The protected **/superadmin** dashboard is the system-wide management area. The superadmin can:

1. Review contact requests, then approve them (create the listing and login) or reject them.

2. Create a listing and login without a request, under **Add an organization**.

3. See every organization admin and whether they are still *Awaiting first sign-in* (still on the default password). **Reset password** gives an organization that lost its password a new default password (see section 1). **Revoke access** removes the login. The superadmin never sees an organization's own password.

4. Edit every facility and ambulance-provider field, including category, location, contact details, services, insurance, bed or fleet counts, coverage and verification status. The *Map location* column shows listings still hidden because no location is set.

5. Review recorded organization-admin updates and superadmin changes.

Permanent deletion

Deletion is permanent. There is no recycle bin or undo button. The dashboard asks for confirmation first. Deleting a facility also deletes its related directory records and organization-admin logins. Deleting an ambulance provider also removes its fleet and coverage records and admins, and clears facility links to it. Check the name and ID before confirming.

Change history

The dashboard displays the latest 200 recorded changes, including listings created by the superadmin, location updates by organizations, edits and deletions.

4. Updating the Droplet safely

After the update has been pushed to GitHub, run these commands on the Droplet:

```
cd /opt/MediFinder
git pull --ff-only origin main
sudo docker compose up -d --build app
sudo docker compose ps
sudo docker compose logs --tail=50 app
curl http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/v1/health
sudo docker compose exec app python -m app.directory_import
```

The last command loads or refreshes the facility directory (section 5). It is safe to run after every update. After any change to the website, press **Ctrl+F5** in the browser so it loads the new design.

On startup the application adds any new tables and columns by itself. **Do not reset or reseed the production database.** Rebuilding only the app keeps the PostgreSQL data volume and existing records. Back up the database volume before large updates. After this update, existing listings are all marked *hospital*, so change clinics and pharmacies to the right category in the dashboard.

Give superadmin access only to a person trusted to manage all FindCare accounts and directory information. Replace demo accounts and placeholder data before real use.

5. The facility directory

FindCare ships with about **2,400 health facilities from across Ghana**, taken from OpenStreetMap, the free map of the world that anyone can edit. Google Maps was not copied, because its terms forbid it.

What is included	About 1,050 pharmacies and chemical sellers, about 920 clinics (including CHPS compounds and health centres), about 365 hospitals, 32 laboratories and diagnostic centres, a few funeral homes (hearse services) and care homes.
Where each one is	Exact GPS position, region, district (metropolitan, municipal or district assembly), city or town, and community. All 16 regions are covered. The district comes from the official boundary the point falls inside.
Contact details	Phone numbers, opening hours and websites appear only where map volunteers recorded them, about 1 record in 8. None has been called.
Services	Only what the place is known to be: pharmacy, dentist, laboratory, eye care, outpatient, or antenatal care and immunisation for CHPS compounds. A clinic or pharmacy whose name says it has a lab also lists Laboratory. Nothing is guessed.
Coverage gaps	Busy cities are well mapped. Rural areas, and the North East and Savannah regions, have far fewer entries. Caregivers and hearse services barely exist in open data, so Contact us is the way to list them.

Loading it on the Droplet

```
cd /opt/MediFinder
sudo docker compose exec app python -m app.directory_import
```

It prints how many places were added, merged, refreshed, left alone or skipped. It **never deletes anything** and is safe to run again.

Rules the import follows

1. A listing that an organization manages (it has a login) or that has been verified is never changed. It belongs to the organization.

2. When an OpenStreetMap place matches a hand-entered listing (same name, within 1 km), the two become one record. It takes the map's location, district, community and any real phone number, and keeps the hand-entered classification, services, insurance and beds.

3. Every imported listing starts as *unverified*. Its page says the data comes from OpenStreetMap and has not been confirmed by the facility.

Credit to OpenStreetMap

The OpenStreetMap licence (ODbL) requires credit wherever the data is shown. The site footer and every imported facility page say *(c) OpenStreetMap contributors*. Keep these credits.

Making the data reliable

Before relying on the directory, call facilities to confirm their phone numbers and correct them in the superadmin dashboard. Facilities that want to manage their own listing use **Contact us**, as in section 1.

6. Website pages

Every FindCare page follows a standard launch checklist:

Page not found	A branded 404 page with links back to search, ambulances and the 112 number, instead of a blank error.
Emergency first	The red **Emergency - find help now** button is at the top of the home page. On phones a bar with **Emergency help** and **Call 112** stays at the bottom of the screen.
Titles and previews	Every page has its own title and description. Links shared on WhatsApp, Facebook or X show a FindCare preview image.
Icons	Browser-tab icon, phone home-screen icons and app icons.
Forms	The contact form explains each mistake under the field and shows *Sending...* while it works. Afterwards it opens a thank-you page explaining the next steps.
Legal	Privacy policy and Terms of use, linked in every footer. They follow Ghana's Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843). Have a lawyer review them.
Search engines	robots.txt and sitemap.xml are made automatically (section 8).
Cookies and statistics	A cookie banner and Google Analytics, only after setup (section 7).

7. Setting up Google Analytics

Google Analytics shows how many people visit FindCare, from where and which pages they use. It stays off until you add your ID.

1. Go to **analytics.google.com** and sign in with the Google account that should own the statistics.

2. Click **Admin** (gear icon), then **Create** and **Property**. Name it *FindCare Ghana*, choose time zone *Ghana* and currency *Ghanaian Cedi*, and continue through the questions.

3. When asked for a data stream choose **Web**, enter **findcareghana.com**, and click **Create stream**.

4. Copy the **Measurement ID** at the top right. It looks like `G-ABC123XYZ`.

5. On the Droplet, add it to the settings file and restart the app:

```
cd /opt/MediFinder
nano .env
#   add this line, with your own ID:
#   MEDIFINDER_GA_MEASUREMENT_ID=G-ABC123XYZ
#   save with Ctrl+O, Enter, then exit with Ctrl+X
sudo docker compose up -d app
curl -s https://findcareghana.com/site-config.js
```

The last command should print your ID. Then open the site in a private browser window. The cookie banner appears; press **Accept**. Within a minute or two your visit shows in Google Analytics under **Reports** then **Realtime**.

How the cookie banner works

1. Statistics are collected **only after a visitor presses Accept**. If they press Decline, nothing is sent to Google.

2. Visitors can change their mind at any time with **Cookie settings** at the bottom of every page.

3. To switch analytics off, delete the ID from .env and run `sudo docker compose up -d app` again. The banner disappears too.

8. Getting found on Google (Search Console)

Google Search Console tells Google about every FindCare page and shows which searches lead people to the site.

Step 1: prove you own the domain

1. Go to **search.google.com/search-console** and click **Add property**.

2. Choose **Domain** (the left box), type **findcareghana.com**, and click **Continue**.

3. Google shows a TXT record starting with `google-site-verification=`. Copy it.

4. Sign in to the company that manages your domain's DNS (where the A record for the Droplet was set). Add a new **TXT** record with name/host @ and the copied value, then save.

5. Back in Search Console click **Verify**. DNS can take a few minutes to a few hours; if it fails, wait and click Verify again.

If you cannot change the DNS, choose **URL prefix** instead and the **HTML file** method. Put the file name Google gives you (for example `google1234abcd.html`) in .env as `MEDIFINDER_GOOGLE_VERIFICATION_FILE=google1234abcd.html`, run `sudo docker compose up -d app`, then click Verify.

Step 2: send Google the list of pages

1. In the left menu open **Sitemaps**, type **sitemap.xml** and click **Submit**. The status should become *Success*.

2. Open **URL inspection**, paste **https://findcareghana.com/** and click **Request indexing**.

3. Over the next days, check **Pages** (what Google has added) and **Performance** (searches that showed FindCare).

What FindCare does automatically

/robots.txt	Tells search engines they may read the public site, and keeps the sign-in pages and the API out of search.
/sitemap.xml	Lists the public pages and every facility and ambulance provider page. New listings are added automatically, so you only submit it once.
Page details	Each page tells Google its main address and title, and the home page describes FindCare Ghana as an organization with its social media accounts.

Search results take days to weeks to appear, and new sites usually start low. Sharing the site and its facility pages on @findcareGh helps.